

Agentic Programming Hackathon

200 high school and university students from western Romania build AI agents that keep a human in the loop. Two days, 100 teams, one national stage. A proposal for Nokia to power the event.

Organizers

agentic.tm · Politehnica
University of Timisoara (UPT) ·
West University of Timisoara
(UVT)

Date

Late November 2026, or 23
January 2027. Locked with UPT
and UVT in early October.

Part of

olimpiada-ai.ro, the national AI
olympiad network

The event in one page

200

participants: 140 high school, 60 university students

100

teams of two, bring your own laptop

44h

Friday 17:00 to Sunday 16:00, on campus in Timisoara

€48,676

total cash budget, including 8% contingency

€22,600

in-kind from the universities and agentic.tm: venue, dorms, GPUs, mentors, design

€25,000

proposed Nokia Title Partner package: credits plus prize pool

What we are asking

We propose Nokia as the Title Partner of the hackathon, at €25,000. That package pays for the two lines that carry a sponsor's name in front of every participant: the developer tooling credits each team uses to build (€17,200, \$20,000) and the prize pool (€8,000). Everything else, food, swag, media, is covered by the universities, by agentic.tm and by Gold and Silver sponsors we approach in parallel.

The credits line is the one that needs the most explanation, so pages 7 and 8 break it down per person, per component, and by who pays it under three scenarios. In the best scenario Cursor and the model providers fund half of it and Nokia's cash need drops accordingly.

What Nokia gets

- **The name on the event.** "Powered by Nokia" on the site, stage, T-shirts, every post and every press mention, through olimpiada-ai.ro's national channels.
- **A Nokia Challenge track** with its own award, on a problem from Nokia's domain, judged by Nokia engineers.
- **Two days with 200 future engineers.** Nokia mentors at the tables, a keynote at the opening, seats on the jury, an opt-in CV book afterwards.
- **A report you can send upward.** Numbers, photos, the recap video and the winning projects, delivered within two weeks of the event.

Why this matters for Nokia Timisoara. Nokia's Timisoara campus employs about 1,300 people, roughly 600 of them R&D engineers, and hires mostly from UPT. The 140 high school students in this room are the UPT intake of 2027 to 2029. The 60 university students are hires of 2027.

Human in the loop

Students build AI agents that reason, plan and act, with a person guiding, approving or correcting them at the points that matter. The agent proposes, the human decides.

Why this theme

The agent systems that work in production today are the ones that keep people in control: a coding agent that opens a pull request for review, a support agent that drafts a reply for an operator, a network agent that proposes a change and waits for an engineer to approve it. Teaching students to design that boundary from their first project is the point of the event.

Teams get developer tooling (Cursor with frontier models) and API access, choose their own stack, and ship a working demo by Sunday noon. There is no fixed problem list. There is a Nokia Challenge track for teams that want a problem from Nokia's world, for example an agent that triages network incidents and proposes fixes an engineer signs off on.

Who participates

GROUP	PARTICIPANTS	WHERE THEY COME FROM
High school students, grades 9 to 12	140	Timis, Arad, Caras-Severin, Hunedoara, through the olimpiada-ai.ro school network and county inspectorates
University students	60	UPT and UVT, years one to three, plus master's students
Total	200	100 teams of 2

Participation is free. Teams register through olimpiada-ai.ro. High school students need a signed parental consent and an accompanying teacher per school group. Two judging tracks (high school, university) so that a 15-year-old is not scored against a third-year student.

The weekend

WHEN	WHAT
Friday 17:00	Check-in, opening, keynote (Nokia slot), theme briefing, hacking starts at 19:00
Saturday	Hacking all day. Mentor office hours, two short workshops (agent design, evaluation), Nokia Challenge briefing
Sunday 12:00	Code freeze and submissions
Sunday 13:00	Demos in front of the jury, two parallel rooms by track
Sunday 15:30	Awards, closing, group photo

Organizers and reach

ORGANIZER	ROLE	BRINGS
agentic.tm	Concept, program, mentors, sponsors	Timisoara's agentic AI community: 200+ members on Discord, 500+ on LinkedIn, monthly meetups since October 2025. Mentors with hands-on LLM and agent experience.
UPT Politehnica University of Timisoara	Venue, accommodation, compute	Amphitheatre and labs, dorm rooms for out-of-town students, GPU cluster for open-weight models, faculty mentors and judges.
UVT West University of Timisoara	Venue, accommodation, compute	Same as UPT, plus the AI and data science faculty. Final venue is chosen between the two campuses when the date is locked.
olimpiada-ai.ro	National umbrella	The Ministry of Education accredited national AI olympiad. Registration, school outreach and national visibility run through its channels.

Who sees the event

4

counties recruited through school inspectorates and the olympiad network

2

universities, both campuses, both student bodies

700+

agentic.tm community members across Discord and LinkedIn

Communication runs on three levels: olimpiada-ai.ro to schools and the ministry network nationally, UPT and UVT to their students and press offices, and agentic.tm to the local tech industry. A recap video and a written report go to every sponsor and to the press after the event.

Precedents in Timisoara

Timisoara already runs hackathons at this scale: HackTM (six days, EUR 10,000 in prizes), UniHack at UPT (48 hours, MLH-sanctioned, open to high school and university students) and ITFest at UVT. What none of them does is put agentic AI and a human-in-the-loop brief in front of high school students with proper tooling. The nearest example is Cluj Hackathon 2025, "AI Agents Everywhere", where a 14-year-old took first place.

What the Title Partner gets

A hackathon is two days of undivided attention from 200 of the strongest young programmers in the region, and a story Nokia can tell for a year afterwards.

Employer brand where hiring happens

Nokia Timisoara hires its engineers mainly from UPT. Every participant in this event is on that path: the university students are one to three years from a first job, and the high school students are choosing a university and a field in the next two years. A Nokia keynote on Friday, Nokia engineers as mentors on Saturday and a Nokia Challenge award on Sunday put the company in front of them as the place where this kind of engineering happens.

The Nokia Challenge track

Nokia defines one problem from its own domain and teams opt in. Two examples we would propose:

- **Incident triage with approval.** An agent reads alarms and logs from a simulated network, proposes a diagnosis and a fix, and waits for an engineer to approve before acting.
- **Configuration review.** An agent reviews a proposed configuration change, explains the risk in plain language, and asks the human the one question that decides it.

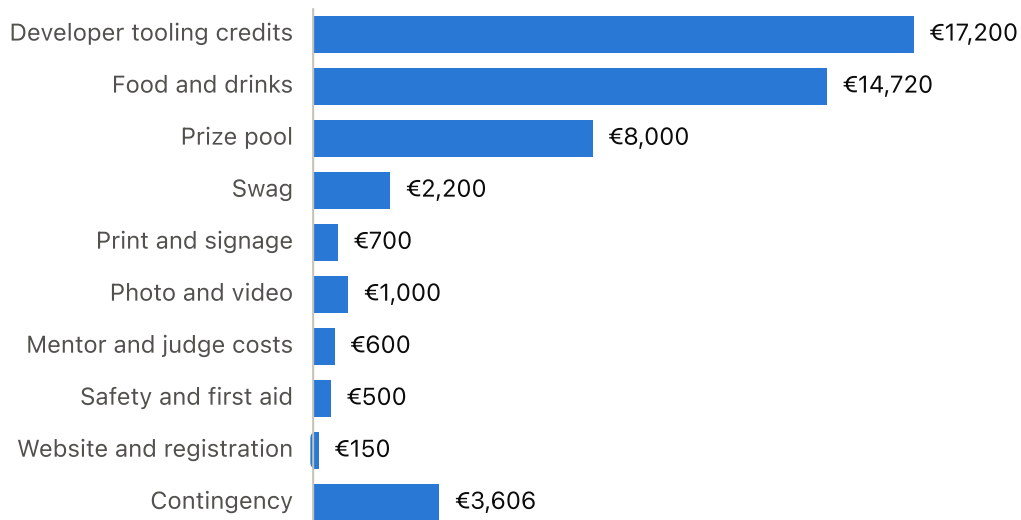
Nokia engineers judge this track and hand out the award. Winning projects come with a short write-up Nokia can reuse internally.

Everything in the package

BENEFIT	DETAIL
Naming	"Powered by Nokia" on the site, registration page, stage backdrop, T-shirts, badges, all social posts and press releases
Keynote	20 minutes at Friday's opening, in front of all participants and teachers
Challenge track	Nokia-defined problem, Nokia judges, Nokia Challenge Award (€1,000)
Mentors	Up to five Nokia engineers on the mentor roster, with visible Nokia badges
Jury	Two seats on the main jury, plus the challenge track jury
Recruiting	Opt-in CV book of participants over 18, a Nokia table at the venue both days
Content	Recap video, photo set, written report with numbers and projects, within two weeks
Community	A Nokia talk at an agentic.tm meetup before or after the event

Where the money goes

Total cash budget €48,676. The universities and agentic.tm add €22,600 in kind, so the venue, beds, compute and mentoring cost the sponsors nothing.

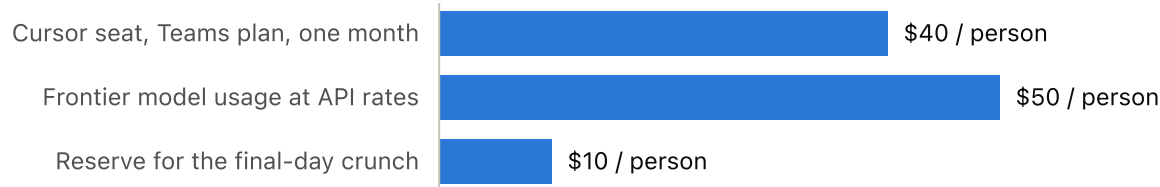


LINE	EUR	BASIS
Developer tooling credits	€17,200	\$20,000 at 0.86 EUR/USD
Food and drinks	€14,720	230 people, six meals plus snacks
Prize pool	€8,000	Two tracks plus three special awards
Swag	€2,200	T-shirts, badges, stickers
Print and signage	€700	
Photo and video	€1,000	
Mentor and judge costs	€600	
Safety and first aid	€500	
Website and registration	€150	
Subtotal	€45,070	
Contingency 8%	€3,606	Price changes, no-shows, last-minute needs
Total cash	€48,676	

Exchange rate 0.86 EUR per USD, mid-September 2026. Food and swag prices are Timisoara catering and print estimates; final quotes come with the date. Pages 7 to 10 detail every line.

The \$20,000 credits line, split

\$100 per participant, \$200 per team, 200 participants. Here is what that buys and why the number is what it is.



COMPONENT	PER PERSON	TOTAL	WHAT IT IS
Cursor seat, Teams plan, one month	\$40	\$8,000	Central billing, spend limits per seat, admin can see usage. Includes Cursor's own usage allowance and unlimited Auto mode.
Frontier model usage at API rates	\$50	\$10,000	Claude, GPT and Gemini calls made through Cursor or through the team's own API key. This is the pool that empties on a hackathon weekend.
Reserve for the final-day crunch	\$10	\$2,000	Topped up only for teams that run dry on Sunday morning. Unused reserve is not spent.
Total	\$100	\$20,000	€17,200

Why \$100 and not \$10

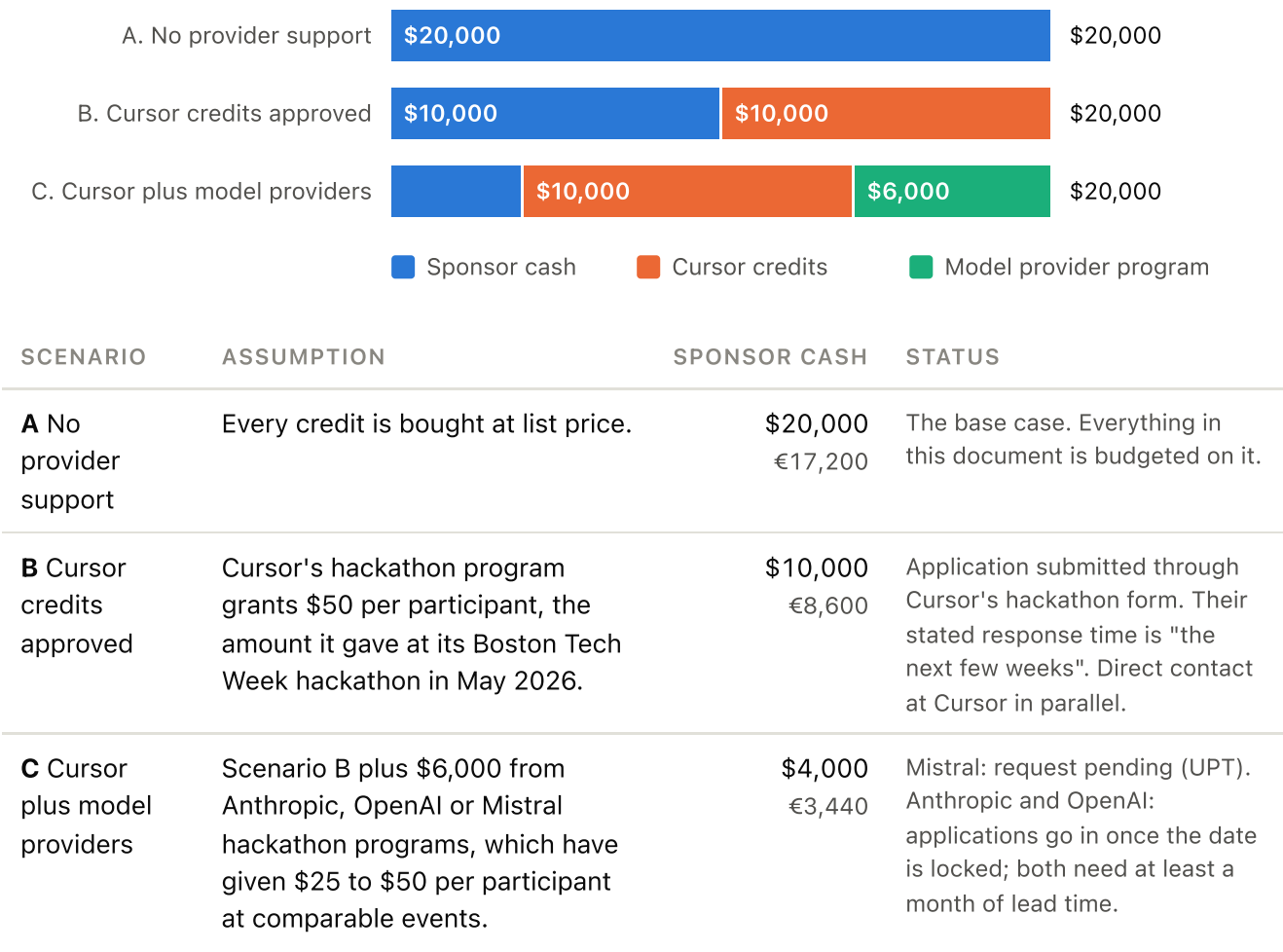
A chat app that calls a model once per message costs cents. An agent turns one task into dozens of model calls, each carrying the whole context of the code so far. A team using a frontier model in an agentic coding tool for two days burns through \$50 to \$150 of usage at list prices. Cursor's own plans show the scale: the \$20 plan includes \$20 of model usage, the \$60 plan \$70, the \$200 plan \$400. We size the pool so a team does not run dry on Saturday evening, and keep a reserve instead of giving everyone the maximum.

How the credits are handed out

- **Seats** live in one Cursor Teams workspace owned by the organizers, one per participant for the event month. Central billing, per-seat spend limit, no card from any student.
- **Model usage** comes from the workspace pool with a hard cap per seat. Teams that want raw API access get a key through a gateway on a UPT server, with the same per-team budget.
- **The reserve** is released on Sunday morning to teams close to their cap.
- **With no credits at all**, every team can still build on free tiers and on open-weight models served from the UPT and UVT GPU clusters. The credits are what put frontier models in their hands.

Who pays the credits: three scenarios

The cash need for credits is \$20,000 if no provider helps, and drops to \$4,000 in the best case. Applications are in progress; the answer decides the sponsor cash.



What this means for Nokia. The Title Partner package is priced on scenario A. Any credits granted by Cursor or a model provider reduce the cash Nokia spends on this line, one for one, and we report the final split in the post-event report. Nokia's package does not grow if the applications fail.

What Cursor can and cannot do

- Cursor grants credits to hackathons "that meet our criteria", case by case. There is no published amount; recent events received \$50 per participant, or prize credits of \$500 to \$3,500.
- Cursor's free year for students closed to new sign-ups in June 2026, so it is not a route for the 60 university students. Cursor does not sponsor food, prizes or venues.
- Nokia's own Cursor licences are not usable: cloud agent features are restricted on Nokia's network. The event runs its own workspace on the universities' and participants' machines.

Food, prizes, swag and the rest

Food and drinks: €14,720

230 people to feed: 200 participants, 10 mentors, 6 judges, 14 organizers and volunteers. Six meals from Friday dinner to Sunday lunch, plus coffee, water and snacks around the clock.

ITEM	COUNT	PER PERSON	SUBTOTAL
Breakfast, Saturday and Sunday	2	€6	€2,760
Lunch, Saturday and Sunday	2	€11	€5,060
Dinner, Friday and Saturday	2	€9	€4,140
Coffee, water, snacks, three days	1	€12	€2,760
Total		€64	€14,720

Catering delivered to the venue, vegetarian option at every meal. Accommodation is not in this budget: UPT and UVT house out-of-town participants in their dorms.

Prize pool: €8,000

TRACK	AWARD	EUR
High school track	1st place	€1,500
	2nd place	€1,000
	3rd place	€500
University track	1st place	€1,500
	2nd place	€1,000
	3rd place	€500
Special awards	Nokia Challenge Award	€1,000
	Best Human-in-the-Loop design	€500
	Community choice	€500
Total		€8,000

Prizes go to teams of two. High school winners receive vouchers rather than cash, which avoids tax and guardianship paperwork for minors. The Nokia Challenge Award is handed out by Nokia's judges.

Partner contributions and the small lines

In kind, already committed: €22,600

These do not appear in the cash budget. They are what the universities and agentic.tm put in, valued at what the organizers would otherwise pay.

CONTRIBUTION	FROM	VALUE
Venue: amphitheatre, labs, network	UPT / UVT	€4,500
Accommodation for out-of-town participants	UPT / UVT dorms	€3,600
GPU cluster for open-weight models	UPT / UVT	€2,000
Design: identity, site, media graphics	agentic.tm	€2,500
Mentoring, 10 mentors, two days	agentic.tm, UPT, UVT	€10,000
Total in kind		€22,600

Venue value is the commercial rate for an amphitheatre plus labs for three days. Accommodation assumes 120 out-of-town participants, two nights each. Mentoring is 10 mentors at 20 hours each, at a senior engineer's day rate.

Everything else: €5,150

LINE	EUR	DETAIL
Swag	€2,200	t-shirts 240 × €7, lanyards and badges 240 × €2, stickers €160
Print and signage	€700	Four roll-ups, one stage banner, posters, room signs.
Photo and video	€1,000	Photographer both days, one edited recap video for sponsors and press.
Mentor and judge costs	€600	Travel for out-of-town mentors, thank-you gifts.
Safety and first aid	€500	Medical assistance on site, consent-form handling for minors.
Website and registration	€150	Domain, hosting, registration and submission tooling.
Total	€5,150	

Contingency of 8% (€3,606) sits on top of all cash lines and is reported back unspent.

Three tiers, one recommended for Nokia

Title Partner

€25,000

Funds the developer tooling credits and the prize pool. One slot. This is the package we propose for Nokia.

- "Powered by Nokia" naming everywhere
- 20-minute opening keynote
- Nokia Challenge track and award
- Up to five mentors, two jury seats
- Logo on T-shirts, badges, stage, site
- Recruiting table, opt-in CV book
- Recap video, photos, written report
- Talk slot at an agentic.tm meetup

Gold

€10,000

Up to two slots. Funds food or the media and swag package.

- 30-minute workshop on Saturday
- Two mentors, one jury seat
- Logo on site, stage, T-shirts
- Recruiting table
- Named in all press and social posts
- Report and photo set

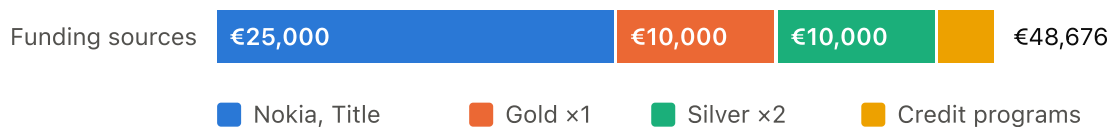
Silver

€5,000

No limit on slots.

- Logo on site and stage
- Swag in the participant bag
- Mention at opening and closing
- Social media mention

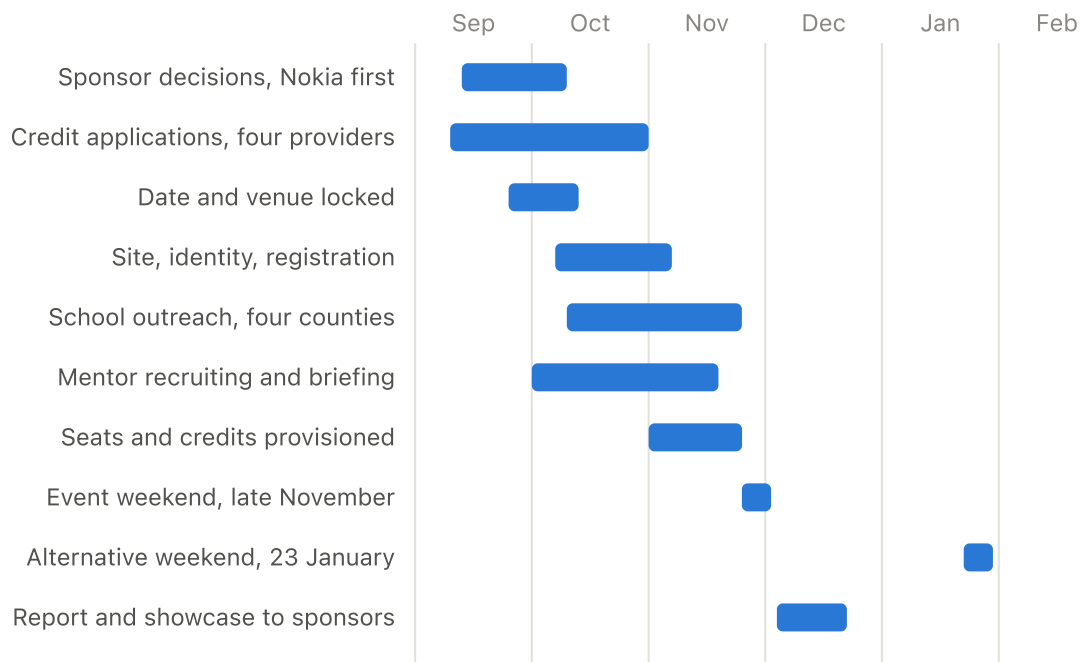
How the budget closes



Gold and Silver conversations run in parallel with this one, starting with companies that already sponsor the national AI olympiad. The last €3,676 is covered by any credit program approval, which lowers the credits line. In-kind partners (a caterer, a print shop, a hardware vendor for prizes) get Silver benefits against the value they contribute.

From today to the event

Two candidate weekends: the end of November 2026, or 23 January 2027. UPT and UVT confirm in early October. Everything before the date lock runs now; everything after shifts by two months if January wins.



Milestones

WHEN	WHAT	OWNER
Week of 21 September	This proposal reviewed with Nokia; sponsor decision requested by mid-October	Vlad, Daniel
By 10 October	Date and venue confirmed with UPT and UVT	Ovidiu
By 10 October	Cursor and Mistral answers on credits; Anthropic and OpenAI applications submitted	Vlad, Ovidiu
By 20 October	Site live, registration open on olimpiada-ai.ro, first school announcements	Marius, Vlad
By 10 November	10 mentors confirmed and briefed; Nokia Challenge problem statement final	Vlad, Nokia
Two weeks before	Registration closes, teams formed, consent forms collected, seats and credits provisioned, end-to-end test of tooling	All

Vlad Temian (agentic.tm) leads the program, sponsors and credits. Ovidiu Baniias handles the universities, date, venue and accommodation. Marius (agentic.tm) does identity, site and media. Daniel Adrelean is the Nokia liaison.

What could go wrong, and what we do about it

RISK	WHAT WE DO
Cursor and the model providers grant nothing	The budget assumes exactly that (scenario A). Any grant is upside. Free tiers and the university GPU clusters guarantee every team can build regardless.
The date slips to January	Both weekends are held with the universities. Registration and outreach are sized for either. Sponsor money is not spent before the date is locked.
Minors and accounts	Seats are created by the organizers in one workspace, so no student signs a contract or enters a card. Parental consent covers participation and photos. An accompanying teacher per school group, medical assistance on site.
Fewer participants than planned	Food, swag and credits scale with headcount. Unspent credits and contingency are reported and returned or rolled into prizes, as the sponsor prefers.
Teams run out of credits	Per-seat caps stop one team draining the pool. The reserve covers the Sunday crunch. Open-weight models on the cluster are the fallback.
Nokia's internal tooling restrictions	Nothing runs on Nokia infrastructure. Nokia's contribution is money, people and a challenge brief.

Next steps

- **This week:** review this proposal together, adjust the package and the prize structure to what Nokia can carry.
- **By mid-October:** Nokia's decision on the Title Partner package, so the name can go on the site and registration materials when they launch.
- **On a yes:** a one-page agreement listing the benefits on page 5, the amount, and the reporting Nokia receives. Invoice from the organizing entity, payable in two parts: half on signing, half after the event with the report.

Contact

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Ovidiu Bantias · universities and logistics

Numbers in this document are estimates as of mid-September 2026 and are updated when quotes and the date come in. Sources for market figures: Cursor pricing and hackathon program pages (cursor.com), Nokia Romania careers pages and press on the Timisoara campus, provider hackathon programs (Anthropic, OpenAI, Mistral, Groq), and the organizers' quotes from Timisoara suppliers.